ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 13: **A Question of Trust (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** a professional thief is fooled by a cleverer impostor	Situational irony.
2	**(d)** he steals once a year and politely helps a stranger	Mild character.
3	**(c)** economical and ironic	Style.
4	**(d)** it assumed no one would appear and ignored the risk of evidence	A weakness.
5	**(c)** the woman acts so naturally that he forgets his own illegal presence	Her confidence masks the situation.
6	**(a)** two thieves choose the same house on the same night	Coincidence drives the plot.
7	**(d)** Is the story's moral about trust or about greed?	Open interpretive.
8	**(b)** gentle, amused sympathy	Light satire.
9	**(d)** trust can be manufactured by confident acting	Trust exploited.
10	**(c)** sceptical	Doubtful.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	He portrays him as gentle, bookish and honest in manner (1) and makes him the victim of a deeper deceit, so we smile rather than condemn (1).	1+1
12	Calamities are reported lightly, such as the arrest (1) and this gentle tone amplifies the comedy and irony (1).	1+1
13	Next to her fraud his crime seems small and gentle (1) so he appears almost innocent by comparison (1).	1+1
14	Horace trusts a stranger while living by deception himself (1) and the woman exploits that trust, showing how trust can be both virtue and weakness (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Horace deceives society by his respectable life. The woman deceives him with a false identity. The layers of deception create irony and give the plot a comic reversal.	1+1+1
16	The woman looks and speaks like a lady and so Horace accepts her. He assumes status equals honesty. The story warns that status can be faked.	1+1+1
17	Her anonymity makes her a figure of cunning and mystery. The reader sees her through Horace's eyes. It keeps the focus on his trust.	1+1+1
	OR: Situational irony: the thief is robbed. Verbal irony: Horace speaks politely to a thief. Dramatic irony: the reader may suspect the woman before Horace does. The three levels enrich the humour.	1+1+1
18	The word 'question' suggests doubt. 'Trust' announces the theme. The reader expects a test of trust and gets a comic lesson.	1+1+1
	OR: Horace acts at once and loses his freedom. The consequence is quick and sharp. The story hints that a moment's thought could have saved him.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Thesis (1). Horace's trust in a stranger (1). The woman's exploitation (1). Counter-view: some trust is necessary (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: She tricked him (1). He chose to commit a crime (1). His fingerprints were his own fault (1). Responsibility is shared (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1

20	Situational irony (1). Verbal irony (1). Dramatic irony (1). Irony in the ending (1). Overall effect (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Clear opening (1). Character and desire (1). The tempting offer (1). The deception revealed (1). Moral ending (1).	2+2+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 13: **A Question of Trust (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** it adds comedy and shows human weakness	A comic imperfection.
2	**(a)** foil	She contrasts with him.
3	**(d)** a person who pretends to be someone else	Impostor.
4	**(a)** none; it is humorous about her cunning	She is a rogue, enjoyed comically.
5	**(c)** its neat reversal depends on a convenient coincidence	Plausible critique.
6	**(c)** justice can be ironic and law may punish the less clever	Irony.
7	**(c)** mistaken trust leads to a series of comic misfortunes	Errors of judgement.
8	**(d)** a third conditional with inversion	Inverted conditional.
9	**(a)** introducing the character's double life	Exposition.
10	**(a)** failure to doubt a convenient story	Naivety.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Books stand for culture and honesty (1) but he steals to buy them, a contradiction that gives the story humour (1).	1+1
12	It is third-person and ironic (1) and it observes Horace with amused detachment while giving his thoughts (1).	1+1
13	It resolves the plot with comic justice (1) and adds depth by giving Horace the books he loves, a final ironic twist (1).	1+1
14	They are the physical proof that traps Horace (1) and show that carelessness undoes careful planning (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	People trust those who appear confident and who offer a plausible reason. Horace's wish to help makes him lower his guard. The story shows that trust needs verification.	1+1+1
16	At the start Horace is a free man planning a theft. At the end he is imprisoned but contented. The reversal of fortune completes the irony.	1+1+1
17	A harsh moral may annoy readers. By wrapping it in humour the writer lets us accept it with a smile. We remember the lesson more easily.	1+1+1
	OR: Horace is an amateur motivated by a hobby and a gentle nature. The woman is a professional motivated by profit. Her skill defeats his innocence. The contrast adds to the irony.	1+1+1
18	The woman is the active agent of the plot. She tests Horace and proves his weakness. Without her, the theme of trust would have no test.	1+1+1
	OR: It reveals the truth to the police and confirms the woman's fraud. It also shows how fast the situation reversed. It completes the proof of Horace's mistake.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Introduction (1). Lesson from Horace (1). Online scams (1). Precautions (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Gentle manners (1). Love of books (1). Mild crime (1). Being cheated (1). Humour (1).	2+2+1
20	Both use gentle humour (1). Here the humour is ironic situation (1). There it is affectionate satire (1). Both teach a lesson (1). Judgement (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Horace's detailed plan (1). The unplanned woman (1). Role of chance (1). Effect on plot (1). Evaluation (1).	2+2+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 13: **A Question of Trust (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** wry	Wry amusement.
2	**(a)** excessive trust and greed bring downfall	Theme.
3	**(d)** poetic justice with a twist	Punishment becomes pleasure.
4	**(a)** to be hoist with one's own petard	Caught in his own scheme.
5	**(b)** leave a smile and a lesson	Comic.
6	**(a)** a thief is both victim and offender	Horace is both.
7	**(c)** a refined passion that leads him astray	Culture and crime.
8	**(a)** The inspector said that his fingerprints were everywhere.	Pronoun and tense shift.
9	**(b)** absent in this story	The woman betrays him.
10	**(a)** its irony and moral	Irony depends on her deceit.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Horace's careful plan is upset by an unplanned meeting (1) so chance can defeat the best preparation (1).	1+1
12	She uses plausible details and confident behaviour (1) and takes advantage of Horace's wish to be helpful (1).	1+1
13	It warns against trust in strangers and against crime (1) but it is told so lightly that the lesson is humorous rather than preachy (1).	1+1
14	Foolish: he trusts too easily and leaves prints (1). Unlucky: he meets a more skilled thief; overall both play a part (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	It gently mocks the idea that respectable people cannot be criminals and that criminals cannot be gullible. It does not attack a class strongly. It is mild satire.	1+1+1
16	The thief was completely fooled by the woman. The passive foregrounds the thief and his humiliation, which suits the ironic focus.	1+1+1
17	She would call him a helpful fool and laugh at his politeness. She would note his skill with the safe. She would claim her victory as skill.	1+1+1
	OR: The break-in and the arrival of the woman create tension. Horace's sneezes and politeness bring laughter. The mixture gives a light-hearted thriller.	1+1+1
18	Horace was careful; however, he left fingerprints. Although he was polite, he was a thief.	1+1+1
	OR: Passion for books drives Horace to crime and loss of freedom. A passion needs limits. The story suggests that even good tastes can lead to harm if pursued wrongly.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Format (1). Governor's curiosity (1). Horace's love of books (1). Humour (1). Ending (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Format (1). Introduction (1). Example (1). Advice (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1
20	Exposition: Horace's double life (1). Complication: the woman (1). Climax: opening the safe (1). Resolution: arrest and prison (1). Effect (1).	2+2+1
	OR: State position (1). Punishment: prison (1). Reward: library (1). Irony of mixture (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.